

PSY 200: Introduction to Psychology

Fall 2026 · Second Session (10 weeks) · Mon Oct 5 – Fri Dec 11, 2026 · 3 credit hours

Instructor	Dr. Taylor Brooks
Email	tbrooks@example.edu
Office	Behavioral Sciences Building 418
Office hours	Wednesdays 1:00–3:00 PM and Fridays 11:00 AM–12:00 PM
Class meetings	Tue / Thu 3:00–4:15 PM, Behavioral Sciences Auditorium
Teaching assistants	Jamal Wright and Emily Novak — exam review sessions
Prerequisite	None.

Course description

A survey of the scientific study of behavior and mental processes. Topics include research methods, the brain and nervous system, sensation and perception, learning, memory, cognition, development, social psychology and psychological disorders. Throughout the course you will learn to evaluate claims about human behavior using evidence.

Learning outcomes

By the end of this course you will be able to:

- Describe the major perspectives and research methods in psychology.
- Explain how biological, psychological and social factors interact to shape behavior.
- Apply principles of learning and memory to improve your own study habits.
- Evaluate popular claims about psychology using scientific reasoning.

Required materials

- Psychology 2e (OpenStax, free online)
- Online quiz access through the course website

Grading

Component	Weight
Weekly online quizzes (8, lowest dropped)	15%
Exam 1	15%
Exam 2	15%
Article analysis paper	10%
Group myth-busting poster	15%
Final exam (cumulative)	25%
Participation	5%
Total	100%

Grading scale: A 90–100 · B 80–89 · C 70–79 · D 60–69 · F below 60. Final grades are not curved; scores are rounded to the nearest whole percent.

Major project

Group myth-busting poster — in groups of four, pick a popular claim (“we only use 10% of our brains,” “learning styles”) and evaluate it with research evidence. Present your findings in a poster session. Deliverables: a topic proposal and the final poster.

Course schedule

The schedule may change with notice; changes will be announced in class and on the course website.

Week	Dates	Topics	Due this week
1	Oct 5 – Oct 9	Psychology as a science; history and perspectives	Sun Oct 11: Online quiz 1
2	Oct 12 – Oct 16	Research methods and statistics	Sun Oct 18: Online quiz 2
3	Oct 19 – Oct 23	Biological bases of behavior	Fri Oct 23: Poster group topic proposal Sun Oct 25: Online quiz 3
4	Oct 26 – Oct 30	Sensation and perception; Exam 1	Thu Oct 29: Exam 1 (Chapters 1–4)
5	Nov 2 – Nov 6	Learning: classical and operant conditioning	Sun Nov 8: Online quiz 4
6	Nov 9 – Nov 13	Memory and forgetting	Fri Nov 13: Article analysis paper Sun Nov 15: Online quiz 5
7	Nov 16 – Nov 20	Thinking, language and intelligence; Exam 2	Thu Nov 19: Exam 2 (Chapters 5–7)
8	Nov 23 – Nov 27	Development across the lifespan (No class Wed Nov 25 – Fri Nov 27: Thanksgiving break)	Tue Nov 24: Online quiz 6
9	Nov 30 – Dec 4	Social psychology; posters due	Tue Dec 1: Group myth-busting poster Sun Dec 6: Online quiz 7
10	Dec 7 – Dec 11	Psychological disorders and treatment; final exam	Thu Dec 10: Final exam (cumulative)

Important dates and deadlines

Date	Item	Type	Time
Sun, Oct 11, 2026	Online quiz 1	Quiz	11:59 PM (online)
Sun, Oct 18, 2026	Online quiz 2	Quiz	11:59 PM (online)
Fri, Oct 23, 2026	Poster group topic proposal	Project milestone	11:59 PM
Sun, Oct 25, 2026	Online quiz 3	Quiz	11:59 PM (online)
Thu, Oct 29, 2026	Exam 1 (Chapters 1–4)	Exam	in class
Sun, Nov 8, 2026	Online quiz 4	Quiz	11:59 PM (online)
Fri, Nov 13, 2026	Article analysis paper	Assignment due	11:59 PM
Sun, Nov 15, 2026	Online quiz 5	Quiz	11:59 PM (online)
Thu, Nov 19, 2026	Exam 2 (Chapters 5–7)	Exam	in class
Tue, Nov 24, 2026	Online quiz 6	Quiz	11:59 PM (online)
Tue, Dec 1, 2026	Group myth-busting poster	Assignment due	11:59 PM
Sun, Dec 6, 2026	Online quiz 7	Quiz	11:59 PM (online)
Thu, Dec 10, 2026	Final exam (cumulative)	Exam	in class

Course policies

Late work and make-ups. Online quizzes close at 11:59 PM on Sunday and cannot be reopened, but your lowest quiz is dropped. The article analysis loses 10% per day late. Make-up exams require documentation and must be arranged within one week.

Academic integrity. All work you submit must be your own. You may discuss ideas with classmates, but written work, code and solutions must be produced individually unless an assignment says otherwise. Using AI tools to generate submitted work is not allowed unless the assignment explicitly permits it; when it is permitted, you must say how you used it. Suspected violations are reported to the Office of Student Conduct.

Accessibility. Students who need accommodations should contact Disability Resources as early as possible and share their accommodation letter with the instructor. All course materials are available in accessible formats on request.

Attendance. Regular attendance is expected and strongly linked to success in this course. If you must miss class, review the posted slides and notes and contact a classmate or the instructor. Absences for illness, religious observance or university-sanctioned events are excused with notice.

Communication. Course announcements are posted on the course website. Email the instructor from your university account and include the course code in the subject line; expect a reply within one business day.

Wellness. Your health matters more than any deadline. If you are struggling, reach out early — the Counseling Center, Academic Success Center and your academic advisor are all free resources.

Getting help

Come to office hours early and often — you do not need a specific question. Free campus resources:

- Academic Success Center — free tutoring and study-skills coaching, drop-in or by appointment
- Writing Center — one-on-one help at any stage of a writing project
- Counseling Center — confidential support for stress, anxiety and other concerns
- Library Research Help — chat, email or in-person help finding and citing sources